

Same medicine. Opposite outcomes.

+1,852%

Eli Lilly

tirzepatide — Mounjaro, Zepbound

+175%

Novo Nordisk

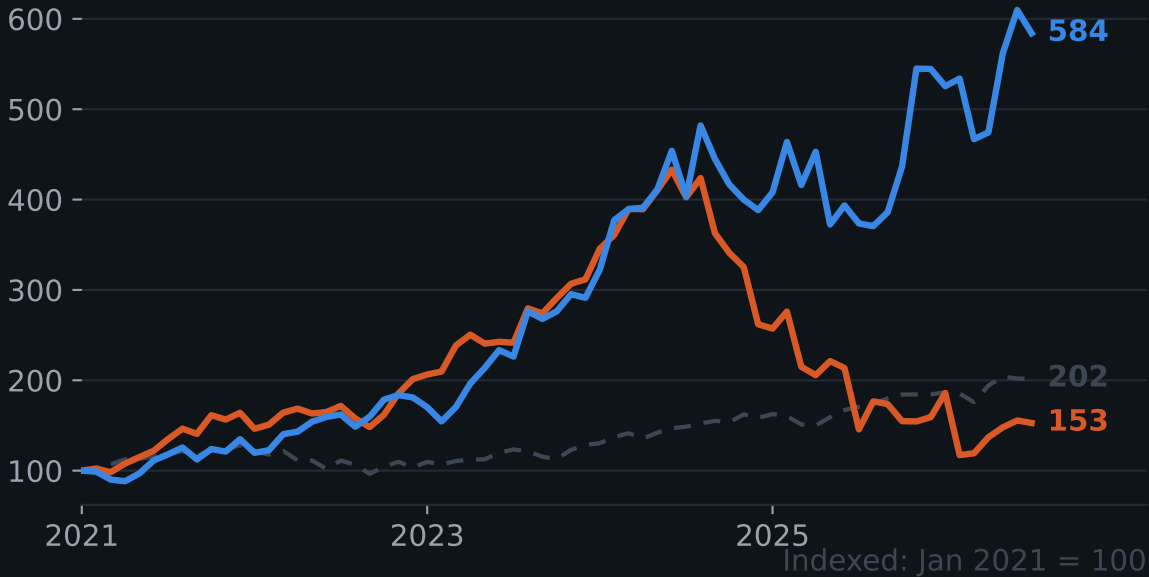
semaglutide — Ozempic, Wegovy

Both companies built the defining medicine of the decade. One produced almost all of the shareholder return.

Total return, Jan 2015 – Jul 2026. USD, dividends reinvested.

PERFORMANCE SINCE 2015

Lilly outperformed. Novo did not.



Eli Lilly
tirzepatide — Mounjaro, Zepbound

+1,852%

Novo Nordisk
semaglutide — Ozempic, Wegovy

+175%

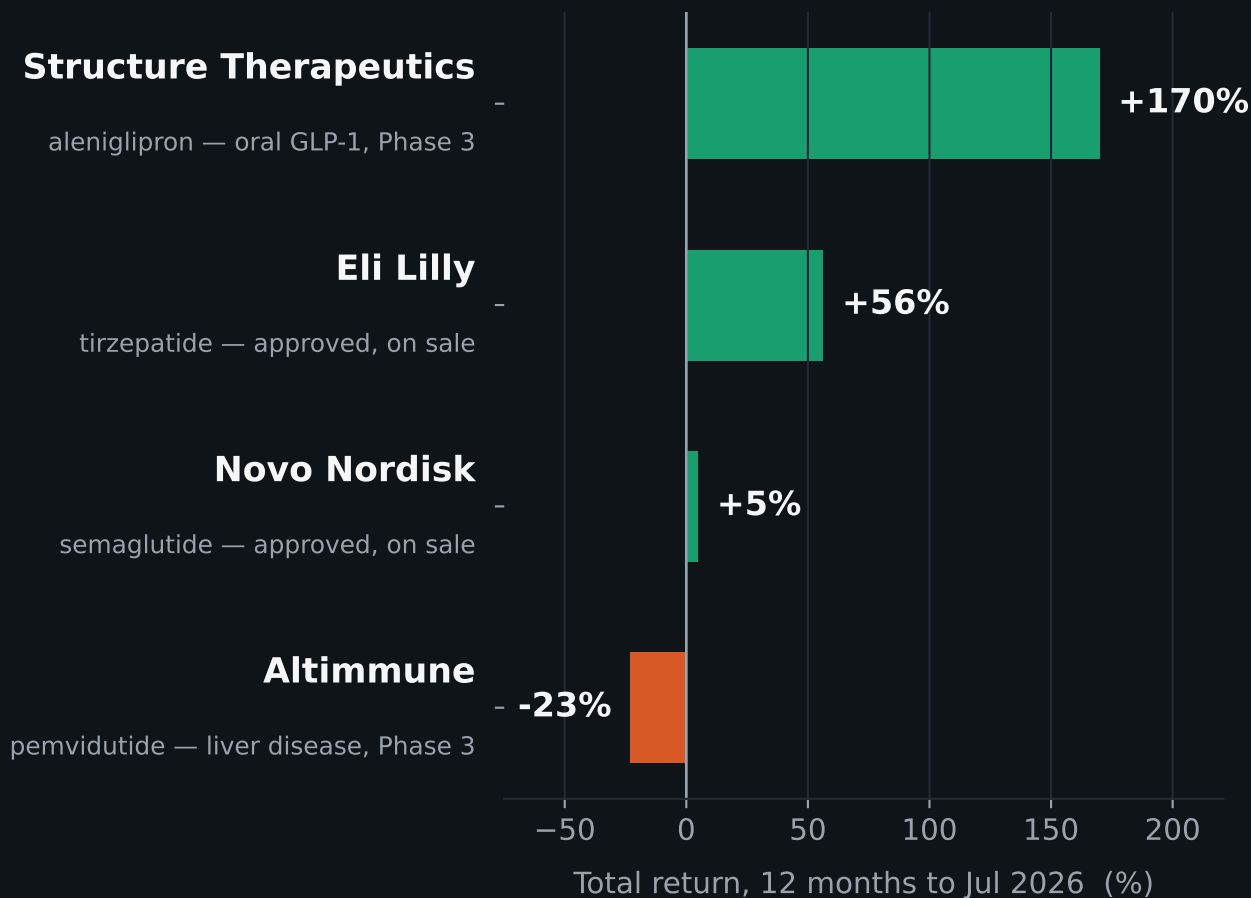
S&P 500
market benchmark

+275%

Novo created the category and still trailed the index.

Total return, Jan 2015 - Jul 2026

Results varied widely.



The highest and lowest performers are both pre-revenue. Their share prices move on trial results, not on sales.

Selection: best and worst of the ten companies, plus the two leaders. All four develop or sell GLP-1 medicines. The broad biotech index rose +72% over the same period; it is not GLP-1 specific.

THE MAIN FINDING

Returns came from one company.

All six GLP-1 companies
equally weighted

+450%

S&P 500
market benchmark

+275%

The same six, excluding Lilly
equally weighted

+170%

Sector exposure alone did not deliver the return.

Excluding one company, the group returned less than the index over the same period.

Held from Jan 2015 to Jul 2026. Total return.

VALUATION

A lower multiple reflects lower expected growth.

	Novo Nordisk	Eli Lilly
Price ÷ earnings	14.1x	39.6x
Expected growth, 5-yr	+7%	+17%
PEG (multiple ÷ growth)	2.26	1.92

A lower PEG indicates better value for the growth expected.

Adjusted for growth, Novo Nordisk is the more expensive of the two.

Only these two companies have approved GLP-1 medicines for obesity on the market. The comparison is the whole market.

Trailing multiples are on reported earnings; consensus growth is on an adjusted basis. Snapshot, not a live figure.

What this does not cover.

These figures show what the market currently expects.

They do not forecast trial outcomes, regulatory decisions, manufacturing capacity or pricing.

Valuation figures are a point-in-time snapshot and move with estimate revisions as well as price.

Full study, charts, data and method

namikakmandev.github.io/glp1-stocks.html

Not investment advice.